# 08-05 第1篇

**The History of Chocolate**

Chocolate is one of the world's favorite treats, but few people know its long and surprising history. The story of chocolate begins over 3,000 years ago in Central America, where the Maya and Aztec peoples first discovered the cacao tree. They used cacao beans to make a bitter drink that was reserved for special ceremonies and royalty. [1] At that time, cacao beans were so valuable that they were sometimes used as money. The Spanish explorers who arrived in the 1500s were the first Europeans to taste chocolate, and they brought it back to Europe.

In Europe, chocolate slowly became popular. At first, it was still a drink enjoyed mainly by the rich and powerful. Sugar was added to reduce the bitterness, and new flavors like vanilla and cinnamon were introduced. [2] By the 1700s, chocolate had spread from Spain to other European countries, and chocolate houses—similar to coffee shops—opened in cities like London. People gathered there to drink chocolate and discuss ideas. Chocolate was no longer just a luxury; it had become part of social life.

The big change came in the 1800s with the Industrial Revolution. Machines were invented to grind cacao beans more finely and mix them with other ingredients. [3] In 1847, a British company made the first solid chocolate bar. Before that, chocolate had always been a drink. The invention of milk chocolate in Switzerland a few decades later made chocolate smoother and sweeter, appealing to even more people. Mass production made chocolate affordable for ordinary families.

Today, chocolate is a global industry worth billions of dollars. It is used in candy, desserts, drinks, and even some savory dishes. [4] However, the chocolate industry faces serious challenges. Many cacao farmers live in poverty, and child labor remains a problem in some regions. Climate change also threatens cacao crops. Consumers are increasingly asking for chocolate that is sustainably and ethically produced.

[5] From a sacred drink in ancient America to a beloved treat worldwide, chocolate has traveled a long path. Its history reminds us that our favorite foods often have stories that connect cultures and centuries.

## 选项

A. Cacao was considered a gift from the gods and was highly prized in trade. B. Chocolate had evolved from a royal drink into a popular social beverage. C. These innovations transformed chocolate from a rare treat into an everyday product. D. As a result, fair trade and sustainable chocolate have become growing trends. E. Chocolate's

journey through time reflects the mixing of cultures and tastes. F. For example, hot chocolate is still enjoyed in many countries during winter.

## 答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

## 深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍玛雅和阿兹特克人用可可豆做饮料、用于仪式，空后说“cacao beans were so valuable that they were sometimes used as money”。选项 A 的“gift from the gods and was highly prized in trade”与“valuable”和“used as money”完全对应，承接仪式用途并解释珍贵原因。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前讲欧洲人加糖、加香料，空后说“chocolate houses opened...People gathered...Chocolate was no longer just a luxury”。选项 B 的“evolved from a royal drink into a popular social beverage”概括从贵族饮品到社会饮料的变化，与后文“part of social life”一致。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍工业革命、机器研磨，空后说“first solid chocolate bar...milk chocolate...Mass production made chocolate affordable”。选项 C 的“transformed chocolate from a rare treat into an everyday product”概括固态巧克力、牛奶巧克力、大规模生产的共同效果，与“affordable for ordinary families”呼应。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：本段讲当代挑战（贫困、童工、气候变化），空后说“Consumers are increasingly asking for...sustainably and ethically produced”。选项 D 的“fair trade and sustainable chocolate have become growing trends”直接承接挑战，并引出消费者需求，逻辑顺畅。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：结尾段总结巧克力历史，空前说“From a sacred drink...to a beloved treat worldwide...stories that connect cultures and centuries”。选项 E 的“journey through time reflects the mixing of cultures and tastes”与“connect cultures and centuries”语义一致，作收尾恰当。
- **干扰项分析**：

- **F. For example, hot chocolate is still enjoyed in many countries during winter.**：虽与巧克力消费相关，但属当代使用场景的具体举例。文中按时间线叙述，F 插入会打断历史脉络；且与 [2] 的“chocolate had always been a drink”易混淆，但 [2] 需概括性过渡句，F 层次错位。